Unlocking Namibia's Potential Through Collaboration

Empowering Industries • Expanding Trade • Building Prosperity





Confidential and Proprietory

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Foreword

The Chamber of Commerce and Industry of India has over decades, positioned itself as an institutional bridge between Indian enterprise and the world, translating diplomatic goodwill into commercial outcomes and translating commercial ambition into structured, bankable engagement. As India deepens its strategic partnership with the African continent, few relationships carry the historical weight and untapped commercial promise of the one it shares with the Republic of Namibia.

India's relationship with Namibia is unusual among India's African partnerships in that it predates Namibia's own independence. India was among the earliest nations to raise Namibia's right to self-determination at the United Nations, hosted the South West Africa People's Organisation's first diplomatic mission abroad, and contributed to the peacekeeping architecture that oversaw Namibia's transition to sovereignty. Prime Minister Narendra Modi's State Visit to Namibia in July 2025, the first visit by an Indian Prime Minister in nearly three decades, has reopened this chapter with renewed energy, and it is CCI India's conviction that the private sector must now translate that political momentum into concrete industrial, commercial and technological partnerships.

Namibia today stands at a genuinely consequential moment in its economic trajectory. It possesses globally significant reserves of uranium, and increasingly of lithium and rare earth elements that are foundational to the clean energy transition; it is emerging as one of the most credible green hydrogen production geographies in the world; it has confirmed offshore oil and gas discoveries in the Orange Basin that are attracting major international capital; and it retains a well-governed, low-corruption, politically stable operating environment that is uncommon on the continent. At the same time, Namibia faces real constraints of scale, skills, infrastructure and industrial depth that India, with its vast manufacturing base, its pharmaceutical and generics industry, its digital public infrastructure, its agricultural technology ecosystem and its pool of engineering and vocational talent, is exceptionally well positioned to help address.

CCI India commits, through this paper and the institutional roadmap it proposes, to serve as a dependable long-term partner in operationalising the India-Namibia economic relationship, one trade mission, one joint venture and one capacity-building programme at a time.



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NAMIBIA

> Experience vast deserts and wildlife, where nature's beauty dominates.



Introduction

Namibia is a sparsely populated country located in Southern Africa with its capital at Windhoek. It is bordered by Angola, Zambia, Botswana and South Africa, and has a long coastline along the Atlantic Ocean. Namibia is known for its political stability, rich mineral resources and well-developed infrastructure compared to many African peers.

India and Namibia share warm bilateral relations, and India maintains a High Commission in Windhoek to promote diplomatic, trade and investment cooperation.

Basic Facts

The capital city of Namibia is Windhoek. The country follows a democratic republican system of government and is a member of the African Union, SADC and the Commonwealth. Namibia is globally known for the Namib Desert, one of the oldest deserts in the world, and for its strong mining sector. The country has a small population but a large land area, making it one of the least densely populated nations in Africa.

GDP (Gross Domestic Product)

Namibia's nominal GDP is estimated to be around US$ 13–15 billion. It is classified as an upper-middle-income economy by African standards. The country has relatively high GDP per capita compared to many African nations, though income inequality remains a challenge. Economic growth is driven mainly by mining, fishing, agriculture, tourism and services.

Trade with India (Bilateral Trade – in Billions)

Trade between India and Namibia is growing steadily. The bilateral trade between India and Namibia is estimated at approximately US$ 0.65–0.75 billion annually. India's exports to Namibia account for around US$ 0.35–0.40 billion, while India's imports from Namibia are estimated at approximately US$ 0.30–0.35 billion. The trade relationship is relatively balanced and driven mainly by minerals and industrial goods.



Culture and Heritage

Namibia's culture reflects diverse ethnic groups like the Himba, Herero, and San, each with distinct traditions and crafts. Music, dance, and oral traditions play a key role in cultural expression. Its heritage is shaped by indigenous beliefs, colonial history, and Christianity, the dominant religion.

Strategic Importance & Key Observations

Namibia is strategically important for India due to its rich mineral resources, political stability and access to the Atlantic shipping routes. For India, Namibia is a key partner in uranium supply, diamond trade and mineral cooperation. There are strong opportunities for Indian companies in mining, renewable energy (especially solar and green hydrogen), fertilizers, healthcare, agriculture, food processing and infrastructure development. With growing focus on green energy and mineral value addition, Namibia offers long-term strategic and commercial potential for India.

Culture & Economic Ties with India

India and Namibia share friendly and stable relations dating back to Namibia's independence, which India actively supported. Namibia strongly supports India at international platforms and the two countries maintain close diplomatic ties. A small Indian community is present in Namibia and is actively involved in trade, retail, pharmaceuticals, hospitality and manufacturing. Namibia also participates in India's ITEC and ICCR scholarship programmes, strengthening educational, technical and institutional cooperation.

Import & Export from India

Namibia exports diamonds, uranium ore, zinc, copper, gold and hides & skins to India. Mineral resources dominate Namibia's export basket. On the other hand, India exports pharmaceuticals, rice, machinery, vehicles, refined petroleum products, iron and steel, chemicals, textiles and engineering goods to Namibia. Indian pharmaceutical products are widely used in Namibia's healthcare sector due to their affordability and quality.

Population

Namibia has a population of approximately 2.7 million people as of 2024. It is among the least densely populated countries in the world. A significant portion of the population lives in urban centers such as Windhoek, Walvis Bay and Swakopmund, while rural communities depend largely on agriculture and livestock rearing. The population is young, offering longterm potential for workforce development.



Currency

The official currency of Namibia is the Namibian Dollar (NAD), which is pegged at par with the South African Rand (ZAR). The stable linkage with the rand helps maintain currency stability and supports regional trade within Southern Africa.



About Namibia

Geography and Strategic Location

Namibia occupies approximately eight hundred and twenty-five thousand square kilometres on Africa's south-western Atlantic coast, bordered by Angola and Zambia to the north, Botswana to the east, South Africa to the south, and a fourteen-hundred-kilometre Atlantic coastline to the west. This coastline, anchored by the deepwater port of Walvis Bay and the emerging port of Lüderitz, gives Namibia a role that few landlocked or poorly connected African economies can match: that of a maritime gateway into the interior of Southern Africa, including Botswana, Zambia, the Democratic Republic of Congo and southern Angola, via the Walvis Bay Corridor network of road and rail links. For Indian exporters and investors targeting Southern African Development Community markets more broadly, Namibia's ports and logistics corridors represent an alternative to routing exclusively through South African infrastructure.

The country's defining physical characteristic is aridity. The Namib Desert, among the oldest deserts on earth, runs the length of the coast, while the Kalahari extends across the country's east. This climate constrains agricultural productivity and water security but has also endowed Namibia with some of the world's clearest skies and most striking landscapes, a combination underpinning a tourism sector built on desert, wildlife and eco-tourism experiences, and with exceptionally strong solar irradiance and coastal wind resources that are now the foundation of the country's green hydrogen ambitions.

Economic Structure

Namibia's economy, valued at approximately US$13–15 billion with a GDP per capita of US$5,000–5,500, was reclassified by the World Bank as a lower-middle-income economy in 2025. The services sector contributes around 55% of GDP, led by trade, financial services, public administration, and logistics through the Walvis Bay Corridor. The primary sector, dominated by mining, contributes about 21%, while manufacturing and construction account for roughly 15%.

Mining remains the backbone of Namibia's economy, contributing around 14% of GDP and nearly 46% of total exports, with uranium and metal ores being the largest export commodities. Economic growth moderated to around 1.7% in 2025 due to weaker agriculture and mining volatility but is expected to recover to 2.4–2.7% in 2026, supported by agricultural recovery, offshore oil investments, and easing interest rates. Inflation remained moderate at around 3.5%, while fiscal and current account deficits widened due to lower revenues and high imports linked to mining and energy investments.

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